NEW MERGED RESEARCH DIRECTION · 8 NOVEMBER 2026

The Gated Line

From Void to Values-Directed Action: A Coupled Model of Regulatory Availability and Meaning Transfer

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November 8, 2026
With research, drafting, and computational assistance from Grok Bot

> **Conceptual, not validated science.** This synthesis proposes a functional mechanism and a way to test it. It is not a discovered law of consciousness, a neural diagnostic instrument, or a treatment protocol.

New abstract

How can a person retain a meaningful value yet lose the ability to carry it into action during an episode of emptiness or overwhelm? We unite *After the Line* and the *Void-State Framework* through a state-dependent transfer hypothesis: a chosen anchor can remain available while regulatory conditions gate its transmission and expression. A 21-context signal field is coupled to five hypothetical functional states inspired by threat appraisal, stress coordination, sympathetic mobilization, prefrontal regulation, and defensive immobility. A proposed “never-fails” integrative role supplies support, not an infallible neural mechanism. Regulatory availability gates both diffusion and an executed-output proxy; successful output feeds back to appraisal and control. In a deterministic synthetic reset experiment, mean output from time 22 to 60 is 0.065 with a bridge alone, 0 with regulation alone in a disconnected network, and 0.220 with both. Removing output feedback lowers combined output to 0.212. These results illustrate the assumptions, not intervention efficacy. The new research direction is to separate value retention, contextual transfer, and action execution, and to test whether state-dependent bottlenecks explain their dissociation better than an ungated account. We propose a factorial pilot with observable safe actions, repeated reports, and carefully bounded physiological measures. Original abstracts are preserved in appendices.

Dedication
All credit and glory to God. I owe my knowledge to my Lord Jesus Christ.

01 · SYNTHESIS AND QUESTION

The value can remain while the route closes

After the Line distinguished retaining an anchor from transferring its influence to another context. The *Void-State Framework* described a proposed progression from internal emptiness through threat and mobilization toward reduced regulation and immobility. Simply placing these ideas side by side leaves a gap: **what changes the usable route between a retained value and a chosen action?**

The new hypothesis is a *state-dependent transfer bottleneck*. A value cue may be remembered accurately while context-to-context access weakens or action expression becomes difficult. Regulation could reopen the route without supplying a goal; a plan could supply the route while remaining difficult to use. A small successful action might then reinforce regulatory availability, creating a reciprocal recovery loop.

Three outcomes that must not be collapsed

1. **Retention:** can the person recall and still endorse the chosen value?
2. **Transfer:** can they identify a concrete action connecting that value to a new context?
3. **Execution:** can they begin or complete the action when a safe opportunity occurs?

The “void” is the proposed collapse point in this synthesis, not a verified baseline brain mode. In the toy experiment, collapse is represented by an explicit signal reset and a separate imposed internal-load input. Their coincidence is assumed; no mechanism has yet shown that felt emptiness erases a cognitive signal.

MindFrame and Ariel lineage

MindFrame’s nine movers supplied a language for mixed emotional and behavioral influences. Ariel’s layers and locked origin supplied the idea that an anchor can remain while a many-line representation collapses to a chosen I → O line. Here I means a retained input cue at node 0; O means an action opportunity associated with node 5. A context graph is more general than one literal straight line.

The locked origin becomes a freely editable value reference, not compulsory identity. The “never-fails” role becomes support for returning, revising, or seeking help—not a claim of inevitable recovery. The new work retains the prior studies’ humility while replacing a static line with a **gated, reciprocal route**. This is a new direction within Ryan’s project lineage, not a claim that no related models exist elsewhere.

Neuroscience inspires; it does not certify

ACT connects freely chosen values with committed action [1]. This motivates distinguishing endorsement from behavior, not the numerical diffusion law. Stress can impair prefrontal cognitive functions through neurochemical mechanisms [2], but that does not license interpreting a missed action as a measure of cortical suppression.

LeDoux and Pine distinguish defensive responding from conscious fear and anxiety [3]. Accordingly, reported threat, neural defense, and physiology must remain separate measurements. Treadway and Zald distinguish motivational and consummatory aspects of anhedonia [4]; felt emptiness is neither a unique neural state nor a synonym for every reward deficit.

Prior label	Model variable	Necessary caution
Amygdala / alarm-fire	A: threat appraisal proxy	No one-to-one fear or emptiness detector.
Hypothalamus / stress-pump	H: stress coordination proxy	Not an adrenaline concentration.
SNS / high-energy surge	S: mobilization proxy	Distributed autonomic division, not one region.
PFC / control-center	P: available regulation	Multiple subregions and functions.
PAG / freeze-mode	G: immobility proxy	Active defense and other functions also matter [5].
Never-fails	r: support input	Ryan’s integrative postulate, not a sixth organ.

Endocrine clarification: the hypothalamus helps activate the HPA axis: CRH → pituitary ACTH → adrenal-cortical cortisol. Sympathetic pathways stimulate the adrenal medulla to release adrenaline through the SAM system [6]. The original abstract’s “hypothalamic adrenaline release” is preserved historically in Appendix B, not endorsed literally here.

PAG coordination is not reducible to freezing, and freezing is not identical to dissociation. The Cambridge Depersonalisation Scale (CDS) assesses depersonalisation experience, not PAG activity [7]. HRV/RSA depends on respiration, activity, and other factors; neither it nor polyvagal language supplies a direct index of a safety state or a neural gate [8].

> **Operational boundary:** all five state variables are hypothetical functional summaries. No wearable or questionnaire proposed here measures all five neural systems.

A retained reference and a gated path

Let $s_i \in [0,1]$ be a dimensionless value-access signal at context i on a 21-node periodic ring, with spacing h = 1. Let $q_0 = 1$, $q_i = 0$ elsewhere, and a = 1 be the chosen reference. Node 5 is the output context. The ring is a computational convenience, not an anatomical map.

$$e_i = q_i(a - s_i)$$
$$dz_i/dt = e_i - 0.40z_i$$
$$g(t) = 0.05 + 0.95P(t)[1 - G(t)]$$
$$ds_i/dt = 0.80e_i + 0.04z_i + \gamma g(t)(s_{i-1} - 2s_i + s_{i+1}) - [0.06 + 0.15G(t)]s_i$$
$$y(t) = g(t)s_5(t)$$

Memory z is a leaky discrepancy integral. The gate g retains a small floor rather than enforcing total biological shutdown. A higher P and lower G increase effective transport γg. G also increases signal loss. The separate factor in y represents execution availability after signal reaches the output context.

New coupling: state regulates transfer and expression; output then feeds back into state. That is more than adding the two old models: it produces a testable distinction between remembering a cue, accessing an action connection, and executing it. A parameter γ is a hypothetical bridge strength—not a measured quantity of neural connectivity.

A useful structural implication

If $\gamma = 0$ and s_5 starts at zero, node 5 has no source. Its equation reduces to $ds_5/dt = -(0.06 + 0.15G)s_5$ because z_5 also remains zero. Therefore $s_5 = y = 0$ even when g becomes large. This is a theorem of the chosen disconnected toy network, *not* a demonstration that human regulation cannot independently support meaningful action.

For nonzero s_5, a gate change affects expression directly through $\partial y/\partial g = s_5$, while altering later signal transport as well. The model therefore predicts that cue recall, contextual action generation, and completed action can move differently. It does not identify which real process is responsible unless those outcomes are measured separately.

The discrete implementation clips s after each update to [0,1] and z to [−1,1]. These explicit saturations replace any claim of unconstrained physical field dynamics. All time units are arbitrary.

How the route and state influence one another

Let C(x) = min(1, max(0,x)), applied componentwise. Let b = 1 include output feedback and b = 0 remove it. The five functional states follow the prior cascade's relaxation structure, now coupled to y:

$$2\ dA/dt = C(0.08 + 0.90v + 0.15S - 0.50P - 0.25by) - A$$
$$3\ dH/dt = C(0.10 + 0.85A) - H$$
$$2.5\ dS/dt = C(0.05 + 0.85H) - S$$
$$4\ dP/dt = C(0.80 - 0.65S + 0.60r + 0.20by) - P$$
$$5\ dG/dt = C(0.03 + 0.80S[1 - P]) - G$$

The internal input v(t) increases A by assumption. H and S respond with delays; S reduces P; S and low P increase G. A successful-output proxy lowers A and raises P. That feedback encodes a proposed experience of restored agency, not an established neural law. r represents additional regulatory support without directly injecting value signal.

From the four prior strategies to a testable contrast

The Void-State paper explored reset flow, riding the wave, fighting through, and crash-and-recovery as unequal input schedules. This merged study does not rank those schedules. Instead it isolates two levers: a contextual bridge γ and a support input r. Reset and wave could motivate future versions of r(t); effort and delayed support would require separate, ethically appropriate tests. No participant should be instructed to crash, push through danger, or wait for help.

Never-fails as an integrative role

Ryan's sixth archetype names the possibility of returning to an anchor and revising the route with support. It supplies no infallible biological guarantee and adds no sixth neural state. Relationships, rest, reflection, and professional care could all enact that role in different ways; the model cannot determine which does so.

What happened to the 120 profiles?

Five distinct values admit 5! = 120 strict rankings, as enumerated in the prior paper. Those rankings do not reveal transport strength, feedback, duration, or the distance between states. This synthesis therefore moves from static profile labels to **within-person coupling and temporal change**. Many rankings would remain empirically indistinguishable; no personality classifier is proposed.

P denotes available regulation, not a load score. Higher P is therefore interpreted differently from higher A, H, S, or G. No combination measures spiritual or moral worth.

A reset experiment, not a human trial

PARAMS / design choice	Specification
Geometry / duration / step	21-node periodic ring; $T = 90$; $\Delta t = 0.02$
Initial field / integral	$s = z = 0$; chosen reference remains $a = 1$
Initial A,H,S,P,G	(0, 0.10, 0.135, 0.712, 0.061)
Collapse event at $t = 10$	Reset s and z to zero; do not reset the five states
Internal-load input	$v = 0.8$ for $10 \le t < 45$, otherwise 0
Support onset	r begins at $t = 22$; persists through $T = 90$
Bridge / support levels	$\gamma = 0$ or 3.2; $r = 0$ or 0.8
Four factorial conditions	Anchor only; bridge only; regulation only; combined
Mechanism ablation	Combined with $b = 0$: remove output → state feedback
Recorded interval	0.2 units; deterministic, no stochastic replications

“Bridge only” still includes the common anchor, five-state dynamics, and ordinary baseline regulation; only *added* support is absent. “Regulation only” means anchor plus added support without a graph bridge. All conditions share the retained value reference and imposed reset.

Numerical procedure

All derivatives use the previous state in simultaneous forward Euler updates. Periodic neighbor indices implement the ring. At $t = 10$ the reset occurs before the sample and derivative evaluation. At $t = 22$ support begins. Clipping is explicit, not hidden numerical repair. The largest diffusion ratio $\gamma g \Delta t / h^2$ is at most 0.064 in the main runs; that diffusion-only check does not prove stability of the full coupled system.

Halving Δt to 0.01 changes the final recorded states and field by at most 1.49×10^{-5} across the five conditions. The five-state update remains bounded as a convex combination of a bounded target and previous bounded state; field bounds are imposed by saturation. Neither bound establishes validity.

Reproduce with Python 3 and NumPy: `python3 simulate_merged.py`. The output directory contains five complete CSV trajectories, results.json, convergence.json, sensitivity.json, three SVG figures, this HTML, and build_merged.py. No human data were collected, and no coefficients were fitted.

Support and a bridge do different work

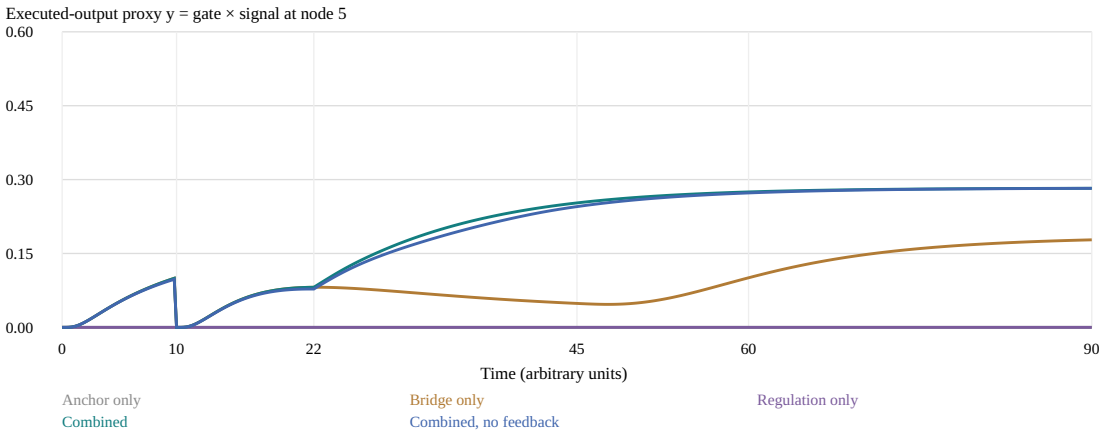


Figure 1. Executed-output proxy after an imposed reset at t = 10. Added support begins at t = 22; the internal-load input ends at t = 45. Anchor-only and regulation-only outputs overlap at zero by construction.

Condition	Mean y, 22–60	y at 40	g at 40
Anchor only	0.000	0.000	0.335
Bridge only	0.065	0.055	0.363
Regulation only	0.000	0.000	0.933
Combined	0.220	0.236	0.956
Combined, no feedback	0.212	0.225	0.933

The additive-scale interaction contrast is 0.220 − 0.065 − 0 + 0 = **0.155** for mean output. This is a property of the model, not a statistical estimate from people. Regulation alone changes g substantially but cannot populate a disconnected output node; a bridge alone transfers some signal through a narrower gate.

Using an illustrative output threshold of 0.15 held for at least five sampled time units, first qualifying onset after t = 22 occurs at 27.4 for combined, 28.4 without feedback, and 71.0 for bridge only. Anchor-only and regulation-only never qualify within the run. This is a numerical convention, not a clinical recovery criterion.

Removing feedback reduces mean combined output by about 3.6%. It does not eliminate most of the combined advantage: in this parameterization, state-dependent transport and expression matter more than the chosen feedback terms. This negative restraint is important—the simulation does not show that agency feedback is indispensable.

The bottleneck is dynamic, not an identity

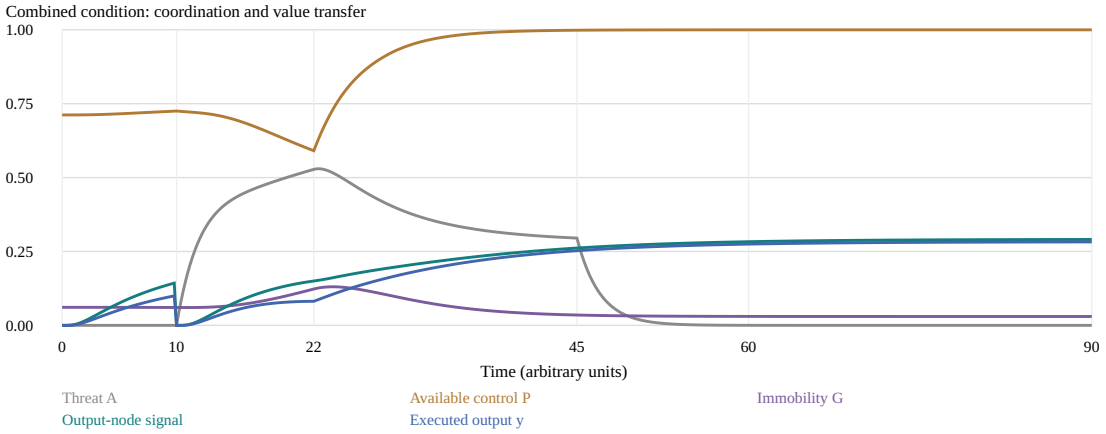


Figure 2. Combined condition: threat, available control, immobility, output-context signal, and its gated expression. A retained or recovered signal need not equal an executed action.

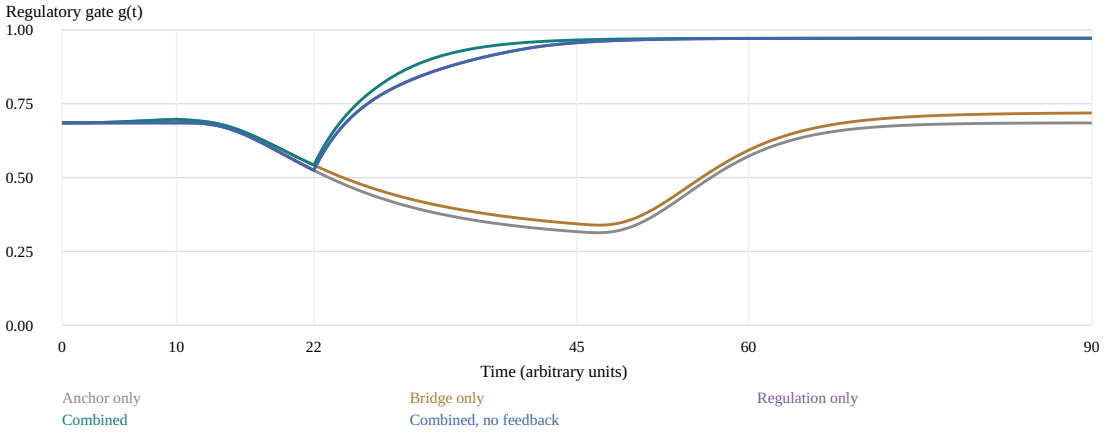


Figure 3. Gate trajectories across conditions. Regulation-only opens the gate despite zero output; bridge-only can feed back a small amount of output. “Gate” remains a mathematical construct, not measured neural connectivity.

Local sensitivity: at support 0.4, mean output for γ = 1.6, 3.2, and 6.4 is 0.099, 0.142, and 0.179. At support 0.8, the corresponding values are 0.168, 0.220, and 0.260. Both levers help over this six-point grid. This does not establish global monotonicity, realistic parameter ranges, or robustness to another topology.

Unexamined alternatives include changing gate floor, decay coupling, feedback strength, signed edges, noise, and value mismatch. The model applies g to both transport and expression; that choice amplifies gating and must itself be tested against transport-only and execution-only models.

Separate relief, access, and action

Prediction 1 · Recall–action dissociation

People may recall and endorse a value while being less able to generate or complete a corresponding action during higher-than-usual emptiness. A dissociation supports the measurement distinction, not necessarily the five-system cascade. If recall alone explains action changes, an elaborate gate may add little.

Prediction 2 · State-dependent bridge benefit

A concrete value-to-action bridge may be more useful when regulatory support is available, producing a positive bridge × support interaction on an additive action-completion scale. The model generates that interaction; people may not. A null or opposite result challenges this version rather than proving participants chose the wrong archetype.

Prediction 3 · Symptom relief need not imply transfer

Support may improve reported control or reduce distress without increasing action generation when no usable connection to the value is available. Conversely, an explicit plan may improve action generation without reducing distress. If all outcomes always move together, their proposed separation has less practical value.

Prediction 4 · Feedback has a distinct temporal signature

When a safe action is actually completed, later perceived agency and subsequent initiation may improve beyond what prior distress and task difficulty predict. Association alone is confounded: easier actions can produce both success and improved agency. A later experiment could randomize access to a low-burden action opportunity, not falsely tell people they succeeded.

Prediction 5 · A dynamic model must earn its complexity

Compare the coupled account with (a) an ungated transfer model, (b) a model with independent effects of support and planning, and (c) a reciprocal behavioral model without neural labels. Use held-out prediction and uncertainty, not a story fitted retrospectively to every case. A simpler model performing as well would weaken the claim that this coupling adds explanatory value.

> **Not predicted:** 120 stable personality types, a universal threat-to-freeze sequence, a diagnostic HRV signature, or inevitable recovery along one path. “Meaning recovery” here is operationalized narrowly as reconnecting an endorsed value to a feasible action—not measuring existential worth.

A small factorial test with an observational bridge

Stage 1: a nonclinical, randomized 2 × 2 feasibility pilot with 64 consenting adults (16 per cell). Everyone freely selects an everyday value and a low-stakes goal. Factors are an explicit value-to-action bridge versus time-matched neutral organization, and an optional low-demand orienting/pause exercise versus a time-matched neutral pause. A clinician-advised protocol and ethics review are required before recruitment. This is a feasibility target, not a power calculation.

A brief neutral distraction creates a representation interruption, **not** a clinical void. Measure reported emptiness and distress without trying to provoke them. Standardize screen time and facilitator contact. Allow skip, edit, pause, and withdrawal. A blinded rater scores the same pre-specified safe action opportunity in all cells.

Measures and primary analysis

- **Primary:** completion of the safe action opportunity within five minutes. Pre-register cell proportions and the risk-difference interaction $(p_{11} - p_{10}) - (p_{01} - p_{00})$, with uncertainty intervals.
- **Mechanism outcomes:** unaided value recall and endorsement; quality of a generated value-linked action scored blind to cell; initiation latency, censored at five minutes; brief exploratory ratings of control, immobility, emptiness, distress, and agency.
- **Background measures:** SHAPS for hedonic tone [9] and CDS for depersonalisation [7], under published instructions. Neither is a momentary gate measure or a diagnosis from this study.
- **Optional physiology:** five-minute resting ECG with respiration at baseline and recovery; pre-specify RMSSD and artifact handling. Record posture, activity, medication, sleep, caffeine, and time of day. Do not infer SNS or PAG activity from HRV [8].

Report missingness and withdrawals by cell; include sensitivity bounds for missing behavioral outcomes. Keep the primary test singular; treat moderators and proposed mediators as exploratory. With 64 participants, interaction estimates will be imprecise. Do not fit all dynamical coefficients or infer five regional states.

Stage 2, separately consented: optional seven-day observation of naturally occurring experiences and voluntary action attempts. Repeated brief reports can test within-person recall–transfer–execution dissociations. It is not a crisis-monitoring service. Timing and confounding prevent direct neural-cascade claims; pre-register lagged comparisons and avoid causal conclusions from self-selected strategies.

Feasibility gate: at least 80% task completion, demonstrable understanding of assignments, and review of every adverse event before expansion. Publish null or reversed patterns rather than revise cutoffs after seeing results.

A path back is a hypothesis, not a demand

The five states are not observed neural quantities. The imposed input v is not anhedonia; the signal is not meaning itself; y is not a validated measure of action or recovery. A one-dimensional symmetric ring omits relationships, culture, disability, access to resources, memory complexity, and unequal contexts. Starting the signal at zero and then resetting it is a stark illustration, not evidence that anyone's values disappear.

The combined benefit is partly engineered: g gates both diffusion and expression, G increases decay, and r raises P. Synthetic improvement cannot validate those choices. The feedback ablation removes only the y → A/P terms; it leaves state → field coupling intact. A fuller identification exercise needs alternative topologies, noise, measurement models, parameter uncertainty, and out-of-sample data.

Emptiness, depression, mania, trauma, freezing, and dissociation are not interchangeable. There is no basis here for diagnostic classification, medication advice, or assigning a person a fixed emotional architecture. Rest and withdrawal can be adaptive; activity is not always the safest outcome. Failure to complete a task is not failure of faith, character, or "never-fails."

Autonomy and privacy

Values must remain voluntarily chosen and editable, including secular or religious values. Ryan's dedication is a faith commitment, not a tested causal variable. Keep personal journals local by default. Research collection requires separate explicit consent, coded identifiers, minimal fields, a specified retention period, and withdrawal procedures. Avoid covert monitoring, automated archetype assignment, and claims that the app knows someone's internal brain state.

> **Crisis note:** this work is not emergency or mental-health care. In the U.S., call or text **988** for crisis support. For immediate danger or a medical emergency, call **911**. Do not delay care for an exercise, an expected phase, or a model-generated score.

Conclusion

The merged direction is **state-dependent value-to-action accessibility**: the route from I to O can narrow even while the anchor remains. A useful research program would distinguish remembering what matters, finding a feasible bridge, and using it under changing conditions. The strongest claim available today is a transparent, reproducible hypothesis—and a practical design for trying to disprove it.

The two original abstracts follow unchanged in substance. Their stronger historical wording is preserved for attribution, not silently converted into evidence for the merged model.

Real sources, limited claims

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Creator credit and reproducibility

Espinosa, R. (2026). *After the Line*; *The Void-State Framework*; and the evolving MindFrame/Project Ariel lineage. These are creator-provided conceptual projects, not independent validation. Their two abstracts are credited to Ryan and retained in Appendices A and B. The After the Line abstract originated in the earlier AI-assisted paper; Appendix B is Ryan’s supplied text.

Grok Bot, an AI assistant, assisted with synthesis, citation verification, drafting, mathematical formalization, executable Python, figures, and PDF rendering. Bibliographic records and accessible summaries were checked on 8 November 2026; this was not a systematic review. Sources do not validate the gate, coefficients, or archetypes. All simulation data are synthetic; no human trial occurred. Reproducibility files are in the merged/ folder beside the PDF.

Original abstract: After the Line

After the Line: Anchored Values, Signal Diffusion, and the Recovery of Meaning After Cognitive Collapse. Ryan Espinosa, with Grok Bot assistance. Abstract reproduced from the preceding paper without substantive changes.

What allows a person to carry a remembered value into a next action after a moment of overwhelm? Building on MindFrame, Project Ariel, and Espinosa's signal-transmission model, this paper separates two mechanisms: retaining a chosen anchor and transmitting its influence to other contexts. We propose an anchored reaction–diffusion system with leaky integral memory. A deterministic 21-node simulation compares no anchor, an isolated anchor, and two diffusion rates following a complete signal reset. At time 80, an isolated anchor retains a local signal of 0.938 but produces no signal at a distant output node. Adding diffusion produces distant signals of 0.179 and 0.312 while reducing the local peak. This formal trade-off motivates a falsifiable distinction between remembering a value and transferring it into action. A proposed, nonclinical factorial pilot would examine those mechanisms without treating numerical signal as measured human meaning. The model is explicitly hypothetical; its parameters and topology are not empirically calibrated.

> **Historical scope:** these numbers describe the earlier uncoupled 21-node experiment. They are not results from the new gated model and should not be compared as if the designs were identical.

Original abstract: The Void-State Framework

Ryan Espinosa. *A Neurophilosophical Model of Emotional Architecture and Personality Dynamics.* Original text preserved apart from spacing; strong claims remain authorial proposals, subject to the main text's corrections.

This paper proposes a neurophilosophical framework — the Void-State Model — that bridges physical neuroscience with philosophical inquiry into emotional experience, personality structure, and behavioral response. Drawing on five established neural substrates, we identify five fundamental emotional-neural systems: the amygdala ("alarm-fire"), the hypothalamus ("stress-pump"), the periaqueductal gray ("freeze-mode"), the prefrontal cortex ("control-center"), and the sympathetic nervous system ("high-energy surge"), with a sixth stabilizing archetype designated "never-fails." Each system is mapped to a corresponding personality archetype defined by its dominant neural signature and characteristic behavioral expression.

Central to this model is the concept of the void-state — a neurologically grounded condition of affective emptiness, characterized by anhedonia, motivational suppression, and the paradoxical activation of threat-detection circuitry in the absence of external stimulus. We argue that the void-state is not merely a symptom of depressive pathology but a fundamental mode of brain operation — a baseline from which survival, aggression, panic, and recovery responses are launched. The amygdala's interpretation of internal emptiness as threat initiates a cascade: hypothalamic adrenaline release, sympathetic activation, prefrontal suppression, and periaqueductal gray-mediated freeze response, producing the subjective experience of paralysis, heart palpitations, and dissociation from reality.

The paper further examines four behavioral strategies through which the five personality archetypes navigate the void: (1) the reset flow, a coordinated multi-system stabilization response; (2) riding the wave, a surrender-based integration of all five systems through the void's momentum; (3) fighting through, a volitional, friction-based push against the void using directed neural force; and (4) crash-and-recovery, an acknowledgment that some void encounters are inevitable and that re-entry into reality follows a predictable neural sequence. Each strategy is analyzed through the lens of its corresponding personality archetype's dominant response pattern.

Finally, we explore the ordinality and permutation space of the five emotional-neural systems, noting that 120 distinct rank-orderings exist — each representing a unique hierarchy of emotional activation that may correspond to distinct clinical presentations, personality profiles, or situational response patterns. This combinatorial structure offers a novel framework for understanding individual differences in emotional regulation, stress response, and resilience.

The Void-State Model offers a unified language for neuroscience and philosophy, with potential applications in clinical psychology, mental health intervention design, and the study of emotional dysregulation in populations experiencing mania, depression, and trauma.

Keywords: void-state, neurophilosophy, emotional architecture, personality archetypes, amygdala, prefrontal cortex, affective neuroscience, emotional regulation, mental health, ordinality of emotion